

THE KHALJIS: ALAUDDIN KHALJI & MARKET REFORMS

KHALJI PHASE CHRONOLOGY → THE KHALJI REVOLUTION DEBATE → ACCESSION AND ANTI-REBELLION CONTROLS → MONGOL PRESSURE AND ARMY → EXPANSION AND CONTROL ZONES → AGRARIAN REVENUE ENGINE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

KHALJI PHASE CHRONOLOGY

KHALJI PHASE CHRONOLOGY

1290 JALALUDDIN

1296 ALAUDDIN SEIZES POWER

1297-1306 MAJOR MONGOL CRISES AND NORTHERN CAMPAIGNS

1303 CHITTOR AND DELHI-SIRI CRISIS

1308-1311 DECCAN EXPEDITIONS

1311 ALAI DARWAZA

1316 ALAUDDIN DIES

1290 Jalaluddin → 1296 Alauddin seizes power

1297-1306 major Mongol crises and northern campaigns

1303 Chittor and Delhi-Siri crisis → 1308-1311 Deccan expeditions

1311 Alai Darwaza → 1316 Alauddin dies

1320 Khusrau Khan falls; Tughlaq transition

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- 1290 Jalaluddin → 1296 Alauddin seizes power
- 1297-1306 major Mongol crises and northern campaigns

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- 1303 Chittor and Delhi-Siri crisis → 1308-1311 Deccan expeditions
- 1311 Alai Darwaza → 1316 Alauddin dies

IMPACT / LIMIT

- 1320 Khusrau Khan falls; Tughlaq transition
- RULE: campaigns, reforms and succession must stay on one dated spine.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: campaigns, reforms and succession must stay on one dated spine.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: campaigns, reforms and succession must stay on one dated spine.

01

STAGE 01

THE KHALJI REVOLUTION DEBATE

THE KHALJI REVOLUTION DEBATE

DELHI, IQTA, COURT IDIOM AND FRONTIER PROBLEM

OLD TURKISH MONOPOLY OF HIGH OFFICE WEAKENED

NOT A MASS REVOLUTION

CULTIVATORS AND ARTISANS DID NOT GAIN EQUALITY

BEST FORMULA

BROADER ELITE RECRUITMENT PLUS INTENSIFIED ROYAL COERCION

KHALJIS DID NOT EXCLUDE ALL TURKS OR ABOLISH INHERITED

CONTINUITY → Delhi, iqta, court idiom and frontier problem

CHANGE → old Turkish monopoly of high office weakened

NOT A MASS REVOLUTION → cultivators and artisans did not gain equality

BEST FORMULA → broader elite recruitment plus intensified royal coercion

LIMIT → Khaljis did not exclude all Turks or abolish inherited institutions.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- CONTINUITY → Delhi, iqta, court idiom and frontier problem
- CHANGE → old Turkish monopoly of high office weakened

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- NOT A MASS REVOLUTION → cultivators and artisans did not gain equality
- BEST FORMULA → broader elite recruitment plus intensified royal coercion

DEBATE / LEGACY

- LIMIT → Khaljis did not exclude all Turks or abolish inherited institutions.
- CONTINUITY → Delhi, iqta, court idiom and frontier problem

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → Khaljis did not exclude all Turks or abolish inherited institutions.

02

STAGE 02

ACCESSION AND ANTI-REBELLION CONTROLS

ACCESSION AND ANTI-REBELLION CONTROLS

DEVAGIRI LOOT

WEALTH AND POLITICAL LEVERAGE

MURDER OF JALALUDDIN

LEGITIMACY AND CONSPIRACY ANXIETY CONFISCATION + INTELLIGENCE + LIMITS

COERCIVE MONARCHY ANSWERED THE REGIME'S INSECURE ORIGIN.

DEVAGIRI LOOT → wealth and political leverage

MURDER OF JALALUDDIN → legitimacy and conspiracy anxiety confiscation + intelligence + limits on

noble feasts, wine and marriage ties isolate elite networks and finance the crown

VERDICT: coercive monarchy answered the regime's insecure origin.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- DEVAGIRI LOOT → wealth and political leverage
- MURDER OF JALALUDDIN → legitimacy and conspiracy anxiety confiscation + intelligence + limits on

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- noble feasts, wine and marriage ties isolate elite networks and finance the crown
- VERDICT: coercive monarchy answered the regime's insecure origin.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- DEVAGIRI LOOT → wealth and political leverage
- MURDER OF JALALUDDIN → legitimacy and conspiracy anxiety confiscation + intelligence + limits on

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT: coercive monarchy answered the regime's insecure origin.

03

STAGE 03

MONGOL PRESSURE AND ARMY REFORM

MONGOL PRESSURE AND ARMY REFORM

MONGOL ASSAULTS

FORTIFIED DELHI-SIRI AND FRONTIER VIGILANCE

LARGE STANDING CAVALRY

CASH SALARY AND REGULAR INSPECTION

HORSE BRANDING

DESCRIPTIVE ROLL

FORTS + COMMANDERS + INTELLIGENCE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- MONGOL ASSAULTS → fortified Delhi-Siri and frontier vigilance
- LARGE STANDING CAVALRY → cash salary and regular inspection

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- DAGH → horse branding
- CHEHRA → descriptive roll

DEBATE / LEGACY

- FORTS + COMMANDERS + INTELLIGENCE → operational defence
- DEPENDENCE → affordable grain prices were tied to sustaining real wages.

- MURDER OF JALALUDDIN → legitimacy and conspiracy anxiety confiscation + intelligence + limits on

06

STAGE 06

MARKET INSTITUTIONAL ARCHITECTURE

MARKET INSTITUTIONAL ARCHITECTUREREGISTRATION, RULES AND SUPERVISIONMARKET ENFORCEMENTREPORTS AND INTELLIGENCE CHECKSCOMPULSORY SUPPLY AND REGULATED CONDUCTPRICE SCHEDULES REQUIRED INFORMATION, SUPPLY AND COERCION TOGETHER.

SULTAN / POLICY

DIWAN-I-RIYASAT → registration, rules and supervision

→

SHAHNA-I-MANDI → market enforcement

→

BARIDS / MUNHIYAN → reports and intelligence checks

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

SULTAN / POLICY

DIWAN-I-RIYASAT → registration, rules and supervision

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

SHAHNA-I-MANDI → market enforcement

BARIDS / MUNHIYAN → reports and intelligence checks

DEBATE / LEGACY

MERCHANTS / TRANSPORTERS → compulsory supply and regulated conduct

RESULT: price schedules required information, supply and coercion together.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RESULT: price schedules required information, supply and coercion together.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: price schedules required information, supply and coercion together.

07

STAGE 07

FOUR REGULATED MARKET CLUSTERS

FOUR REGULATED MARKET CLUSTERSSTAPLE PROVISIONING AND MILITARY REAL WAGESARAI-I-ADL AND REGISTERED TRADEQUALITY, BROKERS AND MILITARY PROCUREMENTGENERAL GOODSDAILY URBAN CONSUMPTIONQUOTED SCHEDULES DEPEND HEAVILY ON BARANI AND REQUIRE UNIT

STRONGEST EVIDENCE CONCERNS DELHI, NOT ONE UNIFORM NATIONAL MARKET.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
GRAIN → staple provisioning and military real wage	HORSES / CATTLE / SLAVES → quality, brokers and military procurement	CAUTION: quoted schedules depend heavily on Barani and require unit discipline
CLOTH / IMPORTS → Sarai-i-Adl and registered trade	GENERAL GOODS → daily urban consumption	SCOPE: strongest evidence concerns Delhi, not one uniform national market.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

GRAIN → staple provisioning and military real wage

CLOTH / IMPORTS → Sarai-i-Adl and registered trade

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

HORSES / CATTLE / SLAVES → quality, brokers and military procurement

GENERAL GOODS → daily urban consumption

DEBATE / LEGACY

CAUTION: quoted schedules depend heavily on Barani and require unit discipline

SCOPE: strongest evidence concerns Delhi, not one uniform national market.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SCOPE: strongest evidence concerns Delhi, not one uniform national market.

08

STAGE 08

GRAIN SUPPLY AND SCARCITY RESPONSE

GRAIN SUPPLY AND SCARCITY RESPONSEDOAB COLLECTIONMERCHANT SUPPLY BANJARAS AND REGULATED TRANSPORTDELHI MARKETS AND STATE GRANARIES FIXED-PRICE SALE + SURVEILLANCECONTROLLED RELEASE AND RATIONING REPORTS

ENFORCEMENT PRESSURE AND EVASION REMAINED PART OF THE SYSTEM.

DOAB COLLECTION / MERCHANT SUPPLY banjaras and regulated transport → Delhi markets and

→

state granaries fixed-price sale + surveillance scarcity → controlled release and rationing reports

→

LIMIT: enforcement pressure and evasion remained part of the system.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

DOAB COLLECTION / MERCHANT SUPPLY banjaras and regulated transport → Delhi markets and

state granaries fixed-price sale + surveillance scarcity → controlled release and rationing reports

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

LIMIT: enforcement pressure and evasion remained part of the system.

DOAB COLLECTION / MERCHANT SUPPLY banjaras and regulated transport → Delhi markets and

DEBATE / LEGACY

state granaries fixed-price sale + surveillance scarcity → controlled release and rationing reports

LIMIT: enforcement pressure and evasion remained part of the system.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT: enforcement pressure and evasion remained part of the system.

09

STAGE 09

MILITARY-FISCAL CAUSAL CHAIN

MILITARY-FISCAL CAUSAL CHAINMONGOL THREAT + IMPERIAL AMBITIONLARGER STANDING CAVALRYCASH SALARIES CREATE PROVISIONING PROBLEMREVENUE EXTRACTION EXPANDS STATE RESOURCESREGULATED GRAIN SUPPLY PROTECTS SOLDIERS' REAL WAGESURVEILLANCE ENFORCES THE CHAIN

ARMY AFFORDABILITY, NOT WELFARE EQUALITY, IS THE STRONGEST MOTIVE.

MONGOL THREAT + IMPERIAL AMBITION

→

larger standing cavalry

→

cash salaries create provisioning problem

→

revenue extraction expands state resources

→

regulated grain supply protects soldiers' real wages

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

MONGOL THREAT + IMPERIAL AMBITION

larger standing cavalry

cash salaries create provisioning problem

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

revenue extraction expands state resources

regulated grain supply protects soldiers' real wages

surveillance enforces the chain

DEBATE / LEGACY

VERDICT: army affordability, not welfare equality, is the strongest motive.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: army affordability, not welfare equality, is the strongest motive.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: army affordability, not welfare equality, is the strongest motive.

09

STAGE 09

MILITARY-FISCAL CAUSAL CHAIN

MILITARY-FISCAL CAUSAL CHAIN

MONGOL THREAT + IMPERIAL AMBITION

LARGER STANDING CAVALRY

CASH SALARIES CREATE PROVISIONING PROBLEM

REVENUE EXTRACTION EXPANDS STATE RESOURCES

REGULATED GRAIN SUPPLY PROTECTS SOLDIERS' REAL WAGES

SURVEILLANCE ENFORCES THE CHAIN

ARMY AFFORDABILITY, NOT WELFARE EQUALITY, IS THE STRONGEST MOTIVE.

MONGOL THREAT + IMPERIAL AMBITION

→

larger standing cavalry

→

cash salaries create provisioning problem

→

revenue extraction expands state resources

→

regulated grain supply protects soldiers' real wages

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- MONGOL THREAT + IMPERIAL AMBITION
- larger standing cavalry
- cash salaries create provisioning problem

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- revenue extraction expands state resources
- regulated grain supply protects soldiers' real wages
- surveillance enforces the chain

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT: army affordability, not welfare equality, is the strongest motive.

MECHANISM / VERDICT —

VERDICT: army affordability, not welfare equality, is the strongest motive.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: army affordability, not welfare equality, is the strongest motive.

10

STAGE 10

EFFECTIVENESS, SOURCES AND LIMITS

EFFECTIVENESS, SOURCES AND LIMITS

DETAILED MECHANISM

LATER, MORALISING AND ARISTOCRATIC

CAMPAIGNS AND COURT CULTURE

CONTEMPORARY PANEGYRIC

DURABLE CLAIMS

NOT PROOF OF MARKET REACH

PROVISIONING AND ARMY SUPPORT UNDER ALAUDDIN

BARANI → detailed mechanism

later, moralising and aristocratic

KHUSRAU → campaigns and court culture

contemporary panegyric

MONUMENTS / COINS → durable claims

not proof of market reach

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- BARANI → detailed mechanism
- later, moralising and aristocratic
- KHUSRAU → campaigns and court culture

METHOD / DEBATE

- contemporary panegyric
- MONUMENTS / COINS → durable claims
- not proof of market reach

HISTORICAL RESULT

- EFFECT → provisioning and army support under Alauddin
- LIMIT → Delhi-centred, coercive, evasion-prone and ruler-dependent
- AFTER 1316 → succession conflict exposes institutional fragility.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: AFTER 1316 → succession conflict exposes institutional fragility.

11

STAGE 11

TOPIC 04 ANSWER SPINE

TOPIC 04 ANSWER SPINE

KHALJI CHANGE COMBINED ELITE WIDENING AND COERCIVE MONARCHY

MONGOLS, CONSPIRACY AND EXPANSION

REVENUE + ARMY INSPECTION + MARKET INSTITUTIONS

INFORMATION + SUPPLY + PRICE SCHEDULE + PUNISHMENT

EFFECTIVE IN CORE OBJECTIVES, GEOGRAPHICALLY AND POLITICALLY BOUNDED

MAJOR MILITARY-FISCAL EXPERIMENT, NOT SOCIALISM OR A MODERN COMMAND

OPEN → Khalji change combined elite widening and coercive monarchy

→

PRESSURE → Mongols, conspiracy and expansion

→

REFORMS → revenue + army inspection + market institutions

→

MECHANISM → information + supply + price schedule + punishment

→

ASSESS → effective in core objectives, geographically and politically bounded

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- OPEN → Khalji change combined elite widening and coercive monarchy
- PRESSURE → Mongols, conspiracy and expansion

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- REFORMS → revenue + army inspection + market institutions
- MECHANISM → information + supply + price schedule + punishment

DEBATE / LEGACY

- ASSESS → effective in core objectives, geographically and politically bounded
- CLOSE → major military-fiscal experiment, not socialism or a modern command economy.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → major military-fiscal experiment, not socialism or a modern command economy.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

THE KHALJIS

ALAUDDIN KHALJI — AGRARIAN & MARKET REFORMS — ADVANCED

1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA

2. KEY CLASSIFICATION

3. STUDY LINKS

4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)

5. UPSC TRAPS

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- The Khaljis: Alauddin Khalji — Agrarian & Market Reforms — ADVANCED
- Mini-timeline
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 3. Study links
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link

LEGACY / NUANCE

- 7. Mains angles
- + Historiography note (PYQ-gap)
- Balban's precedent mattered: he built an exclusive, high-born Turkish nobility , dealt ruthlessly with rivals,
- and used barids (confidential spies) — a template of centralised control Alauddin extended and hardened.

OPTIONAL STATUS —

This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.